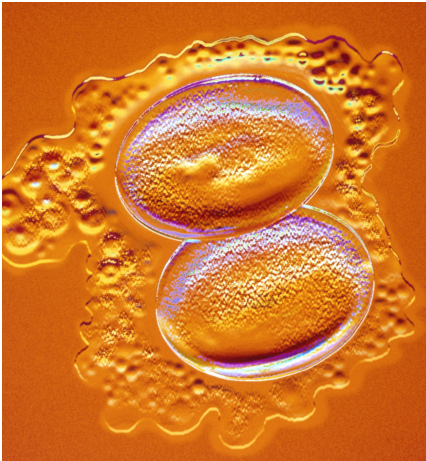




YOU ARE **2 WEEKS AND 3 DAYS**

263 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

When the two nuclei have pooled their genetic material to create a cell containing its full complement of 46 chromosomes—23 each from the mother and father—the cell can start dividing, shown here at the first division creating a two-celled body.

“Vital cell divisions are now taking place as the fertilized egg begins its journey toward implantation.”

The chromosomes from the sperm and egg joined over 24 hours ago. It takes around 30 hours for the resulting zygote to complete its first cell division. The zygote, at only 0.1 mm in diameter goes on to divide into 16 cells, forming a compact ball.

Cell division is such that the ball of cells is hardly any larger than the original zygote. The ball of 16 cells, now known as a “morula” (as it resembles a mulberry), travels toward the uterus, entering on day three to four after fertilization. Every cell within the morula is totipotent, meaning it is able to form any type of cell. From this point onward the cells will lose this function as they start to specialize.

FROM EGGS TO EMBRYOS

Egg collection will be scheduled following the first stage of [IVF](#). Not all follicles that were stimulated will contain eggs. Two days after, you will be given progesterone to thicken the uterus lining. Two to five days after fertilization, the most promising embryos are chosen to be transferred. A pregnancy test is performed about two weeks later. If you are under 40, you will usually have only two to three embryos transferred. Over the age of 40, you may have up to four embryos transferred. Any leftover good-quality embryos can be frozen for future treatment cycles. Research suggests that frozen embryos give comparable pregnancy rates to fresh ones since only the best are selected.

The outcome depends largely on age, but on average each cycle has a 20–40 percent success rate.